

CHAPTER 4

Governance and Public Policy

NCERT Exercise Solutions

The Big Questions	5 Q
Let's Explore · Governance (heavy rainfall in your town)	5 Q
Let's Explore · Understanding Government and Governance	1 Q
Let's Explore · Evolution of Governance in India (the Sengol)	1 Q
Let's Explore · Good Governance (cleanest cities)	1 Q
Let's Explore · Good Governance (State/UT discussion paper)	1 Q
Let's Explore · Challenges to Good Governance (Good Governance Day)	1 Q
Let's Explore · E-Governance (chart of initiatives)	1 Q
Let's Explore · E-Governance (interviews: before and after)	1 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples — write your own.
Independent study aid by Beginers Point. Not an official NCERT publication.

The Big Questions

1 What is governance, and how have its meaning and practice evolved over time?

✔ ANSWER

Governance is the process by which decisions are made, implemented and monitored for the welfare of the people.

In India it grew from old ideas like Sabhā and Samiti, Rājadharma and Rām Rājya (governance as a sacred duty to protect people and their welfare).

Colonial rule brought its own models; after Independence (1947) India framed the Constitution in the spirit of its own values.

Today it is a modern democratic system based on the Constitution, citizen participation and e-governance.

2 What is public policy? How does it affect our day-to-day lives, and what makes it 'public'?

✔ ANSWER

Public policy is a course of action adopted by the government to solve public problems, meet people's needs and promote welfare.

It gives us roads, traffic signals, clean drinking water, electricity, parks and waste collection.

It is ‘public’ because it exists for everyone, is formulated by the government, uses public resources (tax money), promotes public welfare and citizens participate in it.

3 What are the various stages of policy-making and policy implementation?

✔ ANSWER

- Policy desirability (identifying needs and problems)
- Prioritising policy
- Policy formulation (consultation, drafting, checking financial feasibility)
- Policy adoption (framing legislation and regulations)
- Policy implementation
- Policy monitoring
- Policy evaluation (results, impact and feedback)

4 Who are the major contributors to policy-making and implementation?

✔ ANSWER

- Citizens
- Elected representatives (MPs, MLAs, local representatives)
- Government officials, departments and ministries

- Civil society organisations, NGOs, experts, researchers and the media
- Private sector
- International organisations (e.g. WHO)

5 **What role do citizens play in shaping public policy and strengthening good governance?**

✔ ANSWER

Citizens identify problems, vote, express concerns, take part in consultations, give suggestions and share feedback after a policy is implemented.

By following laws, joining community work and holding public authorities accountable, they strengthen democracy and good governance.

⭐ Let's Explore · Governance (heavy rainfall in your town)

a **Who are the different people and organisations involved in dealing with this situation?**

✔ ANSWER

Municipal corporation (clears drains, removes garbage), Public Works Department (repairs roads), police (manage traffic), school authorities, health workers, local representatives and residents/volunteers.

b **Why cannot a single department solve the problem on its own?**

✔ ANSWER

The problem has many parts – roads, drains, traffic, schools, health and electricity. Each department has its own skills and duties, so all are needed together.

c **What would happen if these departments did not communicate or coordinate with one another?**

✔ ANSWER

Work would be delayed or repeated, some areas would be left out, people would get wrong information and the crisis would last longer, causing more harm.

d **What role can citizens play before, during, and after the heavy rainfall?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Before: keep drains free of garbage, follow weather warnings.
- During: help vulnerable neighbours, report flooded areas, avoid spreading rumours.
- After: help in cleaning, keep surroundings clean to stop diseases, give feedback to authorities.

e **What makes the collective response effective? Make a list of the qualities that help the town respond effectively.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Coordination, clear communication, quick response, responsibility (accountability), participation of citizens, and care for the vulnerable (inclusiveness).

⭐ Let's Explore · Understanding Government and Governance

1 **Can you identify more such examples from your day-to-day life to understand the difference between government and governance?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Water supply: the Jal Board/municipality (government) supplies water; governance is how pipelines are planned, leaks are reported by people and fixed, and bills/complaints are handled.
- School: the education department (government) runs schools; governance is how the school is managed with teachers, parents (school committee) and students giving feedback.

- Garbage collection: the municipality provides it; governance includes timing, segregation by residents and complaints about missed pick-ups.

Let's Explore · Evolution of Governance in India (the Sengol)

1 **Try to find out more about the journey of the Sengol through its historic pictures.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The Sengol is a cultural marker of rulership and good governance; its use began over a thousand years ago under the Chola dynasty.

On 15 August 1947, at midnight, Jawaharlal Nehru received the Sengol from the Adheenam saints of Tamil Nadu to mark Independence.

In 2023 Prime Minister Narendra Modi placed it in India's newly inaugurated Parliament building.

(Collect pictures of these events for your project.)

Let's Explore · Good Governance (cleanest cities)

1 **Select two cities (one from another region) that have received awards for being the cleanest city. Make a visual presentation explaining their 'good governance model' – the role of government agencies, residents,**

market associations, civil society – and the steps they take to stay clean.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample: Indore (Madhya Pradesh) and Surat (Gujarat) have won cleanest-city awards in the Swachh Survekshan.

- Government: municipal corporation collects segregated waste from every door, makes compost, fines littering.
- Residents: separate wet and dry waste at home, do not litter.
- Market associations: keep dustbins at shops, clean markets at night.
- Civil society: run awareness drives in schools and colonies.
- To stay clean: regular monitoring, citizen feedback apps, rewards for clean wards.

💬 Let's Explore · Good Governance (State/UT discussion paper)

1. **Prepare a short classroom discussion paper on your assigned State/UT: (1) good governance initiatives being implemented; (2) suggestions for further improving governance.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample outline:

- Initiatives: online services portal for certificates, grievance helpline, schemes for girls' education, public health centres.
- Suggestions: more digital literacy in villages, faster grievance replies, regular social audit of schemes, more public feedback.

(Fill in the real initiatives of your State/UT.)

⭐ Let's Explore · Challenges to Good Governance (Good Governance Day)

1 **25th December is celebrated as National Good Governance Day. Can you find out why this date was chosen? How is it celebrated in your district?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

It is the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister **Atal Bihari Vajpayee**; the day has been observed since 2014 to honour him and spread awareness of good governance.

In districts it is marked with pledges, quizzes, essay competitions, public grievance camps and awareness programmes (find out what your district does).

Let's Explore · E-Governance (chart of initiatives)

1 **Complete the chart of e-governance initiatives (Initiative | Objective) and add two initiatives of your state government.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Initiative	Objective
UMANG	One mobile app to use many government services (Central and State) at one place
Aadhaar	A unique 12-digit identity number for every resident, used to get services and benefits directly
GeM (Government e-Marketplace)	Online platform for government offices to buy goods and services openly and fairly
DigiLocker	Store and share official documents (marksheets, certificates, licence) digitally
CPGRAMS	Online system for citizens to file complaints (grievances) against government offices and track them
APAAR	A permanent academic ID for every student ('One Nation One Student ID') to keep academic records

State initiatives: add two from your state (e.g. a state e-district portal for certificates, an online land records portal).

Let's Explore · E-Governance (interviews: before and after)

1 **Interview seniors, teachers, staff and parents about life before and after e-governance for: birth certificate, admit card, marksheets, salary, rail/flight tickets, vehicle registration. Did they have internet and a smartphone/computer?**

SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample findings:

Service	Before e-governance	After e-governance
Birth certificate	Many visits to the office, long queues	Apply and download online
Admit card	Collected by hand from school/office	Downloaded from a website
Marksheets	Paper copies could be lost or damaged	Kept safely in DigiLocker
Salary	Cash or cheque, delays	Directly in the bank account
Rail/flight tickets	Queues at counters	Booked on phone in minutes
Vehicle registration	Agents and many visits	Online forms and payment

Some older people without a smartphone or internet still needed help, so digital services must be inclusive.

⭐ Let's Explore · Policy or Public Policy?

1 **The government introduces a sports policy.**

✔ ANSWER

Public policy – made by the government for the whole society.

2 **The government launches a campaign to provide safe drinking water to every household.**

✔ ANSWER

Public policy – by the government, for every household, using public money.

3 **A company allows employees to work from home twice a week.**

✔ ANSWER

Policy – applies only to the employees of one company.

4 **A municipality introduces waste segregation in the city.**

✔ ANSWER

Public policy – a public institution makes it for all people of the city.

5 **A housing society fixes visiting hours for guests.**

✔ ANSWER

Policy – applies only to a limited group (members of that society).

6 **The government introduces free vaccination for children.**

✔ ANSWER

Public policy – by the government, for public welfare (health of all children).

⭐ Let's Explore · Participants in the Public Policy Process (traffic at the school gate)

a **Which option did you choose and why?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Option 3: meeting the principal with class representatives and asking that the issue be taken to the local people's representative, so that a traffic signal can be installed. It involves the proper authorities and gives a lasting solution, not just a temporary one.

b **Can you suggest a better solution? Compare your suggestion with other options.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Combine options: a traffic signal and zebra crossing (through the local representative), a pick-up/drop-off point away from the gate (option 5), and student volunteers with traffic police at rush hours (option 1).

A single option (like only volunteers or only a new gate) solves part of the problem; together they reduce jams and make crossing safe.

c **Which stakeholders would be involved in your suggested solution? Explain their role.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Students/class representatives: raise the issue, volunteer.
- Principal and school management: write to authorities, change pick-up point.
- Local representative (councillor/MLA): take the issue to the municipality.
- Municipality/PWD and traffic police: install signal, zebra crossing, manage traffic.
- Parents, rickshaw and bus drivers, shopkeepers: follow the new rules.

d **Suggest a feedback loop to ensure that the problem does not recur.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

A student–parent committee watches traffic every week, records problems, and reports to the principal; the principal sends a monthly report to the traffic police/local representative, and changes are made as needed.

⭐ Let's Explore · Case Study—A Ramp to Better Healthcare

1 **Arrange the various stages of the policy process in sequence for upgrading the hospital to be more patient-friendly.**

✔ ANSWER

1. Problem identified: patients find no ramp, handrails, tactile paths or Braille signs.
2. Issue raised with hospital authorities and local representatives; a disability rights group highlights it in newspapers and social media.
3. District administration takes note; PWD and Health Department inspect the hospital.
4. Consultation with doctors, staff, architects, PwD organisations, senior citizens and residents; plan prepared.
5. Government approves funds.
6. Implementation: ramps, lifts, handrails, tactile paths, accessible toilets and signboards built.
7. Result: the hospital becomes easier to use for all.

2 **Which stakeholders were involved in solving this problem? Identify at least three.**

✔ ANSWER

Patients and their families, local representatives, a disability rights organisation, the media, the district administration, PWD, the Health Department, doctors and hospital staff, architectural experts.

3 **Can you think of any public building in your locality that could be made more accessible? What improvements would you suggest?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample: the local post office or bus stand – add a ramp with handrails, Braille and clear signboards, an accessible toilet, seating for elders and a low counter for wheelchair users.

⭐ Don't Miss Out · NEP 2020 – Stakeholder Role-Play

1 **Each group represents a stakeholder (Union Government, a state government, a school principal, a teacher, a parent, a student, an NGO, a journalist). Discuss how your stakeholder can contribute to the successful implementation of the NEP.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Union Government: give the framework and funds, monitor progress.
- State government: adapt it to the state, train teachers, build facilities.
- Principal: plan activities in school as per NEP.
- Teacher: use activity-based, joyful teaching.
- Parent: support the child's learning and interests.
- Student: learn actively, try skills and new subjects.
- NGO: help in remote areas, run awareness and literacy work.
- Journalist: inform people about NEP and report problems in implementation.

🤔 Think About It · The Making of a Public Policy

1 **If any step in policy-making and implementation is skipped, what would be the implications? Discuss with a suitable example.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Skipping a step makes the policy weak or a failure.

Example: if consultation is skipped, a city may build a footbridge where people do not need it, so nobody uses it.

If monitoring is skipped, as in a tree-planting drive, saplings may die because no one checks whether they are watered.

Every step – consultation, implementation, monitoring and feedback – keeps the policy useful and accountable.

⭐ Let's Explore · Policy Coordination (Khelo Bharat Niti 2025)

1 **As a student, what role can you play in the successful implementation of Khelo Bharat Niti 2025?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Play a sport regularly, take part in school and block-level events, encourage friends (especially girls and specially abled students), take care of sports grounds and give feedback about facilities.

2 **Your school is designated as the 'state's sports ambassador'. What actions should it take to fulfil its role?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Hold regular sports periods, events and inter-school tournaments.
- Find and train talented students with good coaches.
- Keep grounds and equipment in good condition.

- Encourage girls and specially abled students; involve parents.
- Work with local bodies and sponsors for facilities.

3 **Which ministries of the government can contribute towards the success of Khelo Bharat Niti 2025? How?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports: leads the policy, funds and trains athletes.
- Ministry of Education: sports in schools and colleges.
- Ministry of Health and Family Welfare: nutrition, fitness and sports medicine.
- Ministry of Science and Technology: research on better equipment and nutrition.
- Ministry of External Affairs: sports diplomacy, international events.

? Questions and activities

1 **“Good governance is the responsibility of the government alone.” Do you agree with this statement? Give reasons.**

✔ ANSWER

No, I do not agree.

- Governance is the government's responsibility, but good governance depends on how all sections of society perform their duties and work together.
- Citizens elect representatives, follow laws and give feedback.
- The media brings public issues to attention; civil society raises awareness; the private sector brings innovation.
- Good governance is a partnership between the government and citizens.

2 **Do you think students can contribute to good governance? Write a short note describing any five ways in which students can become more responsible and active citizens.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Yes, students can contribute:

- Follow rules and laws (traffic rules, no littering).
- Save water and electricity and keep public places clean.
- Report problems (broken street lights, garbage) to the right authorities.
- Check news before sharing and stop fake news.
- Take part in school councils, awareness drives and community work.

- Encourage elders to vote and use e-governance services.

3 **Choose any one public policy (e.g. RTE, Swachh Bharat Mission, PM POSHAN, Ayushman Bharat, Digital India, Jal Jeevan Mission) and prepare a chart: the problem it addresses, major stakeholders, how actors coordinate, role of citizens.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample – **Swachh Bharat Mission**:

Aspect	Details
Problem	Open defecation, garbage and dirty surroundings causing disease
Stakeholders	Central and state governments, municipalities and panchayats, NGOs, schools, media, citizens
Coordination	Centre gives funds and guidelines; states and local bodies build toilets and manage waste; NGOs and media spread awareness
Citizens' role	Use toilets, segregate waste, do not litter, join cleanliness drives, give feedback

4 (a) **What is governance?**

✔ ANSWER

Governance is the process by which decisions are made, implemented and monitored for the welfare of the people.

4 (b) **How is governance different from government?**

✔ ANSWER

Government refers to the institutions (Legislature, Executive, Judiciary) that exercise political authority; governance is the process of decision-making and implementation, which also includes citizens, media, civil society and private organisations.

4 (c) **What is meant by public policy?**

✔ ANSWER

Public policy is a course of action adopted by the government to solve public problems, meet people's needs and promote the welfare of society.

4 (d) **Name any four principles of good governance.**

✔ ANSWER

Transparency, accountability, participation and the rule of law (also responsiveness, effectiveness, inclusiveness).

5 (a) Compare government and governance in tabular form.

✔ ANSWER

Government	Governance
Institutions that exercise political authority	Process of decision-making and implementation
Includes the Legislature, the Executive and the Judiciary	Includes government, citizens, media, civil society and private organisations
Focuses on who governs	Focuses on how governing is carried out
Institutional aspect	Functional aspect

5 (b) Compare policy and public policy in tabular form.

✔ ANSWER

Policy	Public policy
Made by schools, companies, clubs, housing societies, families	Formulated by the government
Applies to one organisation or a limited group	Applies to society as a whole
Uses the organisation's own resources	Uses public resources (tax money)

e.g. a school's mobile-phone policy	e.g. free vaccination for children

6 **You can prioritise only three of these six points. Which three would you recommend, and which is the most important?**

a. Improve drinking water facilities in schools.

b. Improve sanitation and public toilets in schools and market areas.

c. Provide tricycles for orthopaedically challenged students.

d. Install open-area swings and open-air gym in public parks.

e. Ensure the vaccination of stray dogs to prevent rabies.

f. Ensure distribution of iron and folic acid tablets for female students in schools.

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Sample choice: **(a), (b) and (e)**.

- They meet basic needs of health and safety for a large number of people.
- Most important: **(a) drinking water**, because safe water is needed every day by every student and prevents many diseases.

(Other choices, e.g. (f) or (c) for inclusiveness, are fine if you give good reasons.)

7 Match the policy action point to its stage in the policy cycle.

Policy action point	Stage (jumbled)
1. Assessing the impact of the policy	Policy implementation
2. Putting the policy into action	Policy evaluation
3. Framing the legislation	Policy adoption
4. Multi-dimensional consultation with stakeholders	Policy formulation
5. Addressing a new need of the people	Policy desirability (problem identification)

✔ ANSWER

1 → **Policy evaluation**

2 → **Policy implementation**

3 → **Policy adoption**

4 → **Policy formulation**

5 → **Policy desirability (problem identification)**

8 (a) The government launches a programme to plant one lakh trees in a city. Funds are allocated, but only a few saplings survive because they are not watered or protected. Which stage of the policy cycle appears to be weak?

✔ ANSWER

Policy implementation and **policy monitoring** – the saplings were planted but not cared for, and no one checked their progress.

8 (b) **Which organisations should coordinate to improve the programme?**

✔ ANSWER

The forest/horticulture department, the municipal corporation, resident welfare associations, schools, NGOs and local citizens.

8 (c) **Suggest two measures that could improve the outcome.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Give each sapling a caretaker (a school, RWA or family) and fit tree guards.
- Monitor regularly (e.g. geo-tagged photos) and arrange regular watering, replacing dead saplings.

9 (a) **A good public policy can fail if it is not implemented properly. Agree or disagree?**

✔ ANSWER

Agree. A policy works only when it is put into action well. Example: the tree-planting programme failed because saplings were not watered or protected.

9 (b) **Citizen participation sometimes makes decision-making slower, but it can improve governance. Agree or disagree?**

✔ ANSWER

Agree. Consultation takes time, but it brings in people's needs and ideas, so the policy fits better and people support it. Example: NEP 2020 took about 2 lakh suggestions from consultations.

9 (c) **Technology alone cannot ensure good governance. Agree or disagree?**

✔ ANSWER

Agree. E-governance works only when people have devices, reliable internet and digital skills. Honest officials, active citizens and inclusive services are also needed.

10 **Design a public policy: as a member of your school's student representative body, identify one issue (plastic waste, water wastage, road safety, energy conservation, littering) and prepare a policy proposal: reason, proposed solution, who implements, how students participate, how success is measured.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample – **Save Water Policy**:

- Reason: taps are left open and leak, wasting a lot of water.
- Solution: fix leaking taps, put ‘Save Water’ signs, reuse RO waste water for plants, water monitors in every class.
- Who implements: principal and school management, maintenance staff, eco-club.
- Student participation: class water monitors, awareness posters, reporting leaks.
- Success: compare the school’s monthly water use/bill before and after; fewer leaks reported.

🎉 **Chapter 4 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**